Character Invitations

YOU'RE INVITED TO

The Gravy Boat Murder · A Friendsgiving Mystery

Avery Quill

BARN OWNER & THIS YEAR'S HOST

"Every board in this barn has a story, and you know every one of them."

Your character: Restored Juniper Barn by hand and is hosting the tenth annual Friendsgiving. Knows every creaky board and sticky latch in the place.

What to wear: a cozy sweater dress, a flannel shirt tied at the waist and a big ring of old barn keys; or corduroy trousers, a flannel shirt, a quilted vest and the same ring of keys.



CHARACTER NO. 10

YOUR DISH TO BRING

Roasted pumpkin soup

Store-bought is fine.

DATE _____ TIME _____ PLACE _____ RSVP _____

A clean, cozy whodunit for a Friendsgiving table. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.

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Sage Montrose

THREE-TIME PIE CONTEST CHAMPION

"Your crust is flaky. Your patience is not. Your trophy shelf needs a bigger wall."

Your character: Has won the county pie contest three years running. Goldie was the head judge every time.

What to wear: a cozy plaid dress, a ribbon rosette and a pie server tucked in your pocket; or a tweed vest over a flannel shirt, an apron and the same rosette.



CHARACTER NO. 11

YOUR DISH TO BRING

Maple pecan pie

Store-bought is fine.

DATE _____ TIME _____ PLACE _____ RSVP _____

A clean, cozy whodunit for a Friendsgiving table. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.

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Quinn Delacroix

OWNER OF DELACROIX CIDER MILL

"You press the apples, you warm the cider and you hear every bit of gossip at the urn."

Your character: Has brought the hot spiced apple cider (always alcohol-free) to every Friendsgiving for ten years. Runs the cider urn like a captain at the helm.

What to wear: a denim pinafore over a sweater, an apple-print scarf and sturdy boots; or work trousers, a denim shirt, a canvas apron and the same apple-print scarf.



CHARACTER NO. 12

YOUR DISH TO BRING

Hot spiced apple cider

Store-bought is fine.

DATE _____ TIME _____ PLACE _____ RSVP _____

A clean, cozy whodunit for a Friendsgiving table. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.

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Morgan Feld

COOKBOOK EDITOR

"You can fix any recipe with a red pencil, and most people with a kind word."

Your character: Has edited The Juniper Barn Cookbook since the very first edition, mostly for love. Never seen without reading glasses and a red pencil.

What to wear: a knit dress, reading glasses on a chain and a red pencil tucked behind one ear; or a cardigan over a collared shirt, reading glasses on a chain and the same red pencil.



CHARACTER NO. 13

YOUR DISH TO BRING

Cranberry sauce

Store-bought is fine.

DATE _____ TIME _____ PLACE _____ RSVP _____

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Casey Thornbury

PRODUCER OF SUPPER WITH GOLDIE

"212 episodes, and you can still tell a good story from a bad edit."

Your character: Has produced Goldie's TV cooking show, Supper with Goldie, for six seasons. Rarely puts the camera down.

What to wear: a black turtleneck dress, a headset around your neck and a clipboard; or a black turtleneck, a blazer, a headset around your neck and the same clipboard.



CHARACTER NO. 14

YOUR DISH TO BRING

Mushroom stuffing

Store-bought is fine.

DATE _____ TIME _____ PLACE _____ RSVP _____

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Jules Carraway

GOLDIE'S COUSIN

"Family is everything, especially when the family silver is involved."

Your character: Goldie's cousin and the only family at the table. Grew up eating Goldie's gravy every holiday.

What to wear: a velvet dress in deep plum, a cameo brooch and a family-heirloom shawl; or a velvet blazer, a plum scarf, a cameo pin and polished shoes.



CHARACTER NO. 15

YOUR DISH TO BRING

Cheesy scalloped potatoes

Store-bought is fine.

DATE _____ TIME _____ PLACE _____ RSVP _____

A clean, cozy whodunit for a Friendsgiving table. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.

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Harper Lindqvist

FARMERS' MARKET GROWER

"You grow it, you sell it and you never forget a customer who didn't pay."

Your character: Grows vegetables and herbs and runs the busiest stall at the farmers' market. Supplied the produce for Goldie's show for years.

What to wear: a gingham dress, a straw sun hat and a basket of (pretend) carrots; or overalls over a plaid shirt, a straw hat and the same basket.

DATE _____ TIME _____ PLACE _____ RSVP _____

A clean, cozy whodunit for a Friendsgiving table. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.



CHARACTER NO. 16 · OPTIONAL

YOUR DISH TO BRING

Roasted root vegetables

Store-bought is fine.

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Skyler Bontempo

FOOD TRUCK OWNER

"Your truck is your kitchen, your office and, on long nights, your bedroom."

Your character: Runs a cornbread-and-chili food truck. Parked the truck behind the barn and keeps the cornbread warm in its oven.

What to wear: a bright apron dress, a bandana and a paper order pad; or chef's trousers, a short-sleeved shirt, a bandana and the same order pad.

DATE _____ TIME _____ PLACE _____ RSVP _____

A clean, cozy whodunit for a Friendsgiving table. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.



CHARACTER NO. 17 · OPTIONAL

YOUR DISH TO BRING

Cornbread

Store-bought is fine.

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Arden Fairweather

THE NEIGHBOR NEXT DOOR

"You don't gossip. You simply share information early."

Your character: Lives in the farmhouse next door and has never missed a Juniper Barn Friendsgiving. Knows everyone's business, cheerfully.

What to wear: a floral tea dress, a cardigan and opera glasses on a ribbon; or pressed slacks, a sweater vest, a bow tie and the same opera glasses.



CHARACTER NO. 18 · OPTIONAL

YOUR DISH TO BRING

Green bean casserole

Store-bought is fine.

DATE _____ TIME _____ PLACE _____ RSVP _____

A clean, cozy whodunit for a Friendsgiving table. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.

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Indigo Pike

TURKEY FARMER

"You raised the bird, you roasted the bird and you will hear no jokes about the bird."

Your character: Runs Pike Family Farm and brings the roast turkey every year. Very proud of the bird.

What to wear: a corduroy dress, a feather pin and sturdy farm boots; or a waxed jacket, a flannel shirt, a feather pin and the same boots.



CHARACTER NO. 19 · OPTIONAL

YOUR DISH TO BRING

Roast turkey

Store-bought is fine.

DATE _____ TIME _____ PLACE _____ RSVP _____

A clean, cozy whodunit for a Friendsgiving table. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.

Invitations

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Charlie Okonjo

CHEESE SHOP OWNER

"You know 200 cheeses by smell and every guest by their favorite one."

Your character: Owns the cheese shop on Main Street and builds the autumn cheese board every year. Supplied cheese for Goldie's show.

What to wear: a wrap dress, a cheese-wedge brooch and a little chalkboard name tag; or a waistcoat, rolled sleeves, a cheese-wedge pin and the same chalkboard tag.

DATE _____ TIME _____ PLACE _____ RSVP _____

A clean, cozy whodunit for a Friendsgiving table. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.



CHARACTER NO. 20 · OPTIONAL

YOUR DISH TO BRING

Autumn cheese board

Store-bought is fine.

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Wren Abernathy

GOLDIE'S OLD ROOMMATE

"Ten years away, and you came home to the same old table."

Your character: Shared a tiny apartment with Goldie long ago, then moved abroad for ten years. Just back, and late to dinner.

What to wear: a travel-worn trench dress, a scarf from abroad and a stamped passport; or a trench coat over a sweater, a scarf from abroad and the same passport.

DATE _____ TIME _____ PLACE _____ RSVP _____

A clean, cozy whodunit for a Friendsgiving table. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.



CHARACTER NO. 21 · OPTIONAL

YOUR DISH TO BRING

Homemade dinner rolls

Store-bought is fine.

Open Invitation

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JUNIPER BARN

YOUR CHARACTER (THE HOST FILLS THIS IN)

"A cozy barn, ten years of friendship, one famous gravy boat and a Friendsgiving nobody will forget."

What to wear: cozy harvest best: plaid, corduroy, knits and autumn colors. Your character booklet has two outfit ideas.

Bring: the dish written on the card, plus your best detective face.

YOUR DISH TO BRING

Store-bought is fine.

DATE _____ TIME _____ PLACE _____ RSVP _____

A clean, cozy whodunit for a Friendsgiving table. No acting needed: your booklet tells you what to say.

FOR EVERY GUEST

How the night works

1. **Bring your dish** (it's on your invitation) and set it by your table tent.
2. **Arrive in character**, pick up your name tag and read page 2 of your booklet quietly.
3. **Three rounds:** Appetizers, The Main Course and Pie. Share, ask and try your mission. Evidence cards appear each round; read them, never remove them.
4. **Accusation over coffee:** vote on who, how and why. Then the truth is read aloud.

Innocent characters may dodge questions about their secrets until their booklet says to share. Only one person may lie outright. No drinking tasks, nothing scary: just good food, good friends and a twist.

Text Invitation

COPY · PASTE · SEND

Copy this into an email or group chat. Swap in your details, then send each guest their character, booklet number and dish (or the booklet PDF itself; it reads fine on a phone).

GROUP MESSAGE

You're invited to **The Gravy Boat Murder**, a cozy Friendsgiving murder mystery!

It's the tenth annual Friendsgiving at Juniper Barn. Before the meal, cooking-show star Marigold "Goldie" Ashby tastes the first spoonful of gravy from her antique silver gravy boat, settles into the rocking chair... and never wakes up. Every guest brought a dish. Every guest had a reason. Including you.

When: [date and time]
Where: [address]
RSVP: [by date, to whom]

It's a potluck: your character comes with a dish to bring (store-bought is fine). Dress the part, bring your appetite and your best detective face. It's clean, it's PG, and nobody has to act: your booklet tells you what to say.

PRIVATE MESSAGE TO EACH GUEST

Hi [name]! At The Gravy Boat Murder you'll play **[character name], [role]** (booklet No. [number]). Your dish to bring: **[dish]**. I'll hand you your booklet at the door, or I'm attaching it now. Please only read page 1 for now; it has your outfit ideas. Pages 2–4 wait for the party!

HOST TIP

Fill in the Potluck Planner (file 04) as replies come in, and ask every guest about allergies in the same message.